



cover story UPA MINISTERS

Ramadoss's 117 days abroad include places as varied as Thailand, Kuala Lumpur, Geneva, Seychelles, Canada and Singapore. His 17 jaunts make up 2.54 lakh km.

Anbumani Ramadoss, minister for health and family welfare

P.R. Kyndiah

Minister of tribal affairs

Number of trips: 1

Km travelled: 11,846

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Not provided

K.H. Muniappa

MoS for shipping, road transport

Number of trips: 1

Km travelled: 10,540

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Rs 1.4 lakh

A.R. Antulay

Minister of minority affairs

Number of trips: 1

Km travelled

(personal visit): 6,112

OFFICIAL EXPENSES: Nil

G.K. Vasan

MoS (I.C.) for statistics and programme implementation

Number of trips: 1

Km travelled: 9,387

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Not provided

K. Venkatapathy

MoS for law and justice

Number of trips: 1

Km travelled: 11,572

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Not provided

S.S. Palanimanickam

MoS for finance

Number of trips: 1

Km travelled: 1,370

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Rs 2.7 lakh

T. Subbarami Reddy

MoS for mines

Number of trips: 1

Km travelled (personal

visit): 7,678

OFFICIAL EXPENSES: Nil

Kapil Sibal

Minister for science & technology, and earth sciences & ocean development

Days as minister: 1,287

NUMBER OF TRIPS: 24

Official: 23

Personal: 1

DAYS ABROAD: 113

Official: 106

Personal: 7

Km travelled: 3,97,813

Official: 3,93,405 km

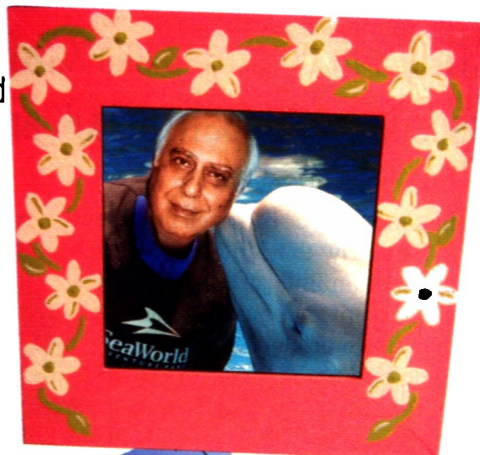
Personal: 4,408 km

OFFICIAL EXPENSES*:

Rs 11.7 lakh

*Airfare not included

Sibal has toured the US six times and has spent 18 days on a trip to Malaysia, China and Brazil.



Home Alone Netas

Ministers who didn't go to any foreign shore during their regime

M.H. Ambareesh

MoS for information and broadcasting

J.P.N. Yadav

MoS for water resources

M.V. Rajasekharan

MoS for planning

Manik Rao Gavit

MoS for home affairs

S. Jegadeesan

MoS for social justice & empowerment

Taslimuddin

MoS for agriculture, consumer affairs, food and public distribution

V. Radhika Selvi

MoS for home affairs

So many peripatetic ministers spending so much of public money seems surprising considering that the PMO ostensibly scrutinises every request for official travel abroad and has been trying to be tight-fisted in its clearances. Sources in the PMO suggest that the expenditure and travel itinerary would have been longer, had the PMO not stalled some habitual travellers. Apparently, the PMO cannot do much when

faced with ministers from the coalition allies. The cynical view would be that this too is a coalition expenditure but the facts reveal that the big travellers in the UPA are seasoned Congressmen.

It was Rajiv Gandhi who had coined the phrase "Government on the move". Even he would have been surprised at the distance the UPA Government has travelled—abroad, that is.